

# MUSTHALIF MEERAN

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## Education

### B.S. Abdur Rahman Crescent Institute Of Science And Technology

*Specialization: Cloud Technology & Network Security*

Chennai

- Master of Computer Application GPA: 9
- Bachelor of Computer Application GPA: 8.7

## Technical Skills

**Cloud:** Prisma Access, SASE, Cloud Security, Virtual Firewall, AW, DLP, App-ID / User-ID / Content-ID.

**Operation:** Incident Response, RCA, SOP, Packet Capture Analysis, DR, Protocol Debugging, CRQ, RFC / CAB.

**Software Tools:** SolarWinds, Cisco WLC, Cisco DNA, Wireshark, NetFlow, Grafana, ServiceNow, ClearPass NAC.

**Security:** Palo NGFW, Panorama, GlobalProtect, DDoS/DoS, CDL, ISE, SSL, SIEM, IPS/IDS, WAF, Cloudflare, Strata.

**Automation:** Python (Netmiko, NAPALM, Paramiko, RESTCONF), Ansible, YAML, Git, CI/CD, JSON, REST APIs .

**Network:** MPLS, QoS, AAA, ACL, NAT, FHRP, VLAN, STP, BGP (iBGP/eBGP), OSPF, EIGRP, DHCP, DNS, NTP.

**SD-WAN:** Palo Alto Prisma ION, Secure Edge, Zero-Touch Provisioning, Path Quality Profile, IPsec Overlays, EVPN.

## Work Experience

### R.R. Donnelley

Feb 2025 – Present

*Senior Network Security Engineer*

Chennai

- **Managed 150+ sites Palo Alto NGFW, Panorama device** groups/templates, security policies, NAT, U-Turn, VPN (IPsec/GlobalProtect), SSL Decryption, HA, zone-based segmentation, and threat-prevention tuning
- Deployed Palo Alto Prisma SD-WAN with App-ID routing, dynamic path selection, secure fabric links, **IPsec tunnels, QoS, ZTP** onboarding, next-gen firewall integration, and boosting WAN performance and security across branches.
- Managed high-volume ServiceNow incidents/requests with RCA, config reviews, compliance checks, and documentation across Cisco switching, Aruba AP/Controller, Palo Alto NGFW/GlobalProtect, **Panorama, SD-WAN (ION)**, VLAN, BGP/OSPF, and Zero Trust environments.
- **Led refresh of 30+ sites replacing routers**, switches, APs, firewalls, and SD-WAN; designed VLAN segmentation, routing (**BGP/OSPF**), QoS, and **IT/OT segmentation**. **Implemented firewall hardening**, IDS/IPS, vulnerability remediation, and centralized logging (**Syslog/NetFlow/SIEM**) to improve security and performance..
- **Led firewall rule cleanup across 80+ Palo Alto NGFW using Panorama and Python automation (REST APIs/Netmiko)**, identifying unused rules, resolving **shadowed policies**, and **optimizing NAT and security policies** (App-ID/User-ID). Enhanced security posture, compliance, and policy governance through **rulebase optimization, log analysis, and automated auditing**, reducing attack surface and improving operational efficiency.
- Deployed **20+ Palo Alto NGFW (out-of-box) with routing, NAT, VPN (IPsec/GlobalProtect), SSL decryption, IDS/IPS, and threat prevention**; implemented HA, firewall migration, secure remote access, and **network segmentation**. Performed **SIEM/log monitoring, packet capture, and troubleshooting to detect intrusion**, malware, and data exfiltration while ensuring uptime.
- Managed 700+ Cisco & Aruba switches, VLANs, STP, FHRP, OSPF, BGP, QoS, EtherChannel, **MPLS** and firmware upgrades and implemented campus network refresh for access/distribution/core, and end-to-end L2/L3 troubleshooting.

### Intellect Design Arena

Sep 2022 – Feb 2025

*Junior Network Security Engineer*

Chennai

- **Analyzed P1/P2 incidents using ServiceNow, SIEM, Syslog, and NetFlow, performing RCA across Palo Alto NGFW, Cisco routing/switching, VPN, and IDS/IPS environments**. Implemented monitoring, alert tuning, and configuration optimization (firewall, routing, NAT) to reduce incidents and improve SLA, uptime, and security posture.
- **Designed and implemented SD-LAN and Network Access Control (NAC) solutions using Cisco ISE with 802.1X authentication, TACACS+, RADIUS, dACLs, profiling, posture assessment, and TrustSec (SGT)** for identity-based access control and network segmentation across wired and wireless networks.
- Delivered end-to-end network security automation by implementing zero-touch firewall provisioning, threat monitoring, compliance audits, IPsec VPN automation, and **firewall rule optimisation** using Python, Ansible, APIs, Netmiko, Palo Alto, and Cisco security technologies.

- **Implemented enterprise Wi-Fi** using **Cisco WLC, Wi-Fi 6/802.11ax, RF Optimisation, Cisco DNA Centre, Mobility Groups**, secured with WPA3, 802.1X, RADIUS, supporting 2000+ endpoints.
- **Designed and implemented DDoS/DoS mitigation using Palo Alto NGFW** protection profiles, rate limiting, zone protection, ACLs, and traffic filtering to secure critical applications and network infrastructure.**Performed traffic analysis, anomaly detection, and tuning using NetFlow, packet capture (Wireshark), and SIEM/Syslog** to ensure high availability, resilience, and effective threat detection.

## Projects

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**Cisco Automation**

NetMiko | Ansible | Python

- **Python & Ansible automation** for Cisco, Palo Alto, and Aruba—parallel backups, config templating, REST API/NETCONF scripts, compliance auditing, log parsing, and zero-touch provisioning—boosting operational efficiency by 80% and reducing mean time to execute changes (MTTC) by 70%.

**Cisco ISE Access Control**

TACACS+ | RADIUS | NAC

- Engineered **Cisco ISE architecture with 802.1X authentication**, dynamic ACLs, downloadable ACLs, profiling policies, **TrustSec SGT mapping**, posture validation, and CoA workflows—reducing rogue device events by 70% and increasing compliance accuracy by 45%.

**SolarWinds Network Monitoring**

SME | Troubleshoot | Utilization

- Deployed and optimised **SolarWinds NPM/NTA** with **SNMPv3, NetFlow, Syslog correlation, custom alerting**, and performance dashboards—cut MTTR by 50%, reduced P1 outage duration, **prevented SLA penalties**, and safeguarded 5–8 Lakh/year in downtime-related business impact.

## Relevant Coursework

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- CCNP Enarsi/Encore
  - Network Automation
- Network Troubleshooting
  - Computer Architecture
- Palo Alto SD-WAN
  - Cisco DNA
- PCNSE
  - NetScaler ADC